YEAR 10 GCSE HISTORY EXAM BOOSTER

Specification Overdue Radar & High-Probability Topic Booster

2-PAGE REVISION DOSSIER

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–1939 (1HI0/31) • Edexcel GCSE (9–1) Examination Series 2018–2026

⚠ **EXAMINER RADAR ALERT:** Pearson Edexcel rotates high-tariff topics. The 5 topics below have been either *completely unexamined* or *absent for 4+ exam series*.

TARGET: SUMMER 2026 / MOCK EXAMS

TOP 5 HIGH-PROBABILITY OVERDUE EXAM TOPICS

#1

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 1: The Weimar Republic 1918–29 • 1 The origins of the Republic, 1918–19

- The situation in Germany at the end of the War: political unrest, abdication of the Kaiser, armistice and new republic.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#2

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 1: The Weimar Republic 1918–29 • 1 The origins of the Republic, 1918–19

- The strengths and weaknesses of the new Weimar Constitution.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#3

OVERDUE (2020)

Key topic 1: The Weimar Republic 1918–29 • 3 The 'Golden Years': recovery of the Republic, 1924–29

- Reasons for economic recovery, including the work of Stresemann, the Rentenmark, the Dawes and Young Plans and American loans and investment.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#4

OVERDUE (2020)

Key topic 1: The Weimar Republic 1918–29 • 3 The 'Golden Years': recovery of the Republic, 1924–29

- Stresemann's achievements in gaining international acceptance of Germany abroad through the Locarno Pact and joining the League of Nations.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#5

HIGH-TARIFF ESSAY GAP

Key topic 3: Nazi control and dictatorship, 1933–39 • 1 The creation of a dictatorship, 1933–34

- The Reichstag Fire. The Enabling Act and the banning of other parties and trade unions.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

⚡ RAPID RETRIEVAL HINGE CHECK (5 CORE QUESTIONS)

1 **What agreement did Hitler sign with the Catholic Church in July 1933, and what did it promise?**

Answer Key: The Concordat (Reichskonkordat): Hitler agreed not to interfere in Catholic worship, schools, or youth leagues if priests stayed out of politics.

2 **Name the anti-Nazi Protestant organization set up by Martin Niemöller in 1934.**

Answer Key: The Confessing Church (and the Pastors' Emergency League).

3 **What two major constitutional weaknesses undermined the Weimar Republic from 1919?**

Answer Key: Proportional Representation (fostered unstable coalitions) and Article 48 (presidential emergency decree power).

4 **Which international treaties restored Germany's diplomatic standing between 1925 and 1928?**

Answer Key: The Locarno Pact (1925), entry into the League of Nations (1926), and the Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928).

5 **What was the official name of the papal encyclical issued in 1937 attacking Nazi violations of the Concordat?**

Answer Key: "Mit Brennender Sorge" (With Burning Concern) issued by Pope Pius XI.

GRADE 9 EXEMPLAR MODEL ANSWER

Explain why the Nazis were able to control religious groups in Germany in the years 1933–39. (12 marks)

The Nazi regime employed a two-pronged strategy of legal appeasement followed by systematic intimidation, censorship, and co-optation to neutralize Christian religious influence between 1933 and 1939.

PEEL Paragraph 1: Firstly, Hitler initially neutralized the Roman Catholic Church through diplomacy. In July 1933, the Nazis signed the Concordat (Reichskonkordat) with Pope Pius XI, promising not to interfere in Catholic youth organizations and schools provided the Church remained out of politics. However, once his power was consolidated, Hitler systematically broke this treaty by closing Catholic youth leagues, shutting down Catholic schools, and arresting priests on fabricated currency smuggling and immorality charges. When Pope Pius XI issued the encyclical "Mit Brennender Sorge" (With Burning Concern) in 1937 condemning Nazi racism and paganism, the Gestapo seized all copies and intensified the persecution of Catholic clergy, effectively silencing open opposition.

PEEL Paragraph 2: Secondly, the Nazis attempted to unify and control Protestant Christians by creating a coordinated state church. In 1933, the German Evangelical Church was consolidated into the Reich Church under the leadership of Nazi-appointed Reich Bishop Ludwig Müller. Pastors who joined the "German Christians" movement wore Nazi uniforms and placed swastikas on altars, seeking to remove Jewish Old Testament scripture from Christian theology. Although dissident pastors such as Martin Niemöller and Dietrich Bonhoeffer formed the rival Confessing Church to protect theological independence, the Gestapo ruthlessly arrested over 800 pastors, including Niemöller who was sent to Dachau concentration camp in 1938, neutralizing organized resistance.

PEEL Paragraph 3: Furthermore, the regime established state-controlled alternatives to diminish Christian influence in daily life. Through the Ministry of Church Affairs established under Hanns Kerrl in 1935, religious education was phased out of schools, crucifixes were removed from classrooms, and young people were required to join the Hitler Youth and League of German Girls, which scheduled activities on Sunday mornings to directly compete with church attendance. A small number of extreme Nazis also promoted the pagan "German Faith Movement" to replace Christian rituals with state festivals.

⚠ CHIEF EXAMINER PITFALL WARNING:

Chief examiners report that candidates frequently confuse the Concordat (Catholic) with the Reich Church (Protestant), or make generic assertions that "Hitler banned all religion". High-scoring responses clearly distinguish between policies toward Catholics versus Protestants and provide specific names (e.g. Ludwig Müller, Martin Niemöller, Pope Pius XI).

PUPIL PRE-EXAM TRAFFIC LIGHT SELF-CHECK

Specification Overdue Topic	Core Facts Mastered?	Essay Plan Ready?
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write

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